Our brand

Our brand is more than a logo or visual identity—it's the expression of who we are, what we stand for, and the value we deliver.

Our guidelines provide the foundation for understanding the SEI brand, including our purpose, positioning, personality, voice, and visual identity. From logo usage and typography to messaging and digital experiences, these elements work together to create a consistent, recognizable brand and help us build meaningful connections with our audiences.

From acronym to brand

SEI is a brand name, not an acronym. SEI began as an acronym tied to the company's original name. As the organization has evolved, however, those initials have become something more than a shorthand for its beginnings. Today, SEI stands on its own as a recognized brand, representing the company's expertise, innovation, and impact. While the historical meaning remains part of the company's heritage, it no longer defines who we are or how we present ourselves. SEI should be treated as a standalone brand name in all communications.

Brand messaging

Brand voice

Follow these guidelines for all content you create for SEI.

Our voice is:

- Confident, not defensive
- Plainspoken, not academic
- Evidence-led, not self-congratulatory
- Client-centric, not SEI-centric
- Strong POV, minimal filler

Focus on:

- Clean, confident, minimal systems
- Language that is:
  - declarative (not descriptive)
  - specific (not abstract)
  - repeatable (not campaign-y)

Avoid:

- “We feel,” “We think”
- Competitor baiting/negative framing
- Overuse of scale stats without meaning
- Long process-heavy paragraphs
- Redundant explanations
- Generic boilerplates
- “Empowering innovation”
- “Transforming the future of finance”

customer response.

- **affect as a noun** is a psychological term rarely used in everyday language.
- **effect as a noun** means result: *The effect was immediate.*
- **effect as a verb** means to cause or to carry out. It's often followed by the word "change:" *She will effect change in the department.*

affinity groups

- Former name for our **employee resource groups (ERGs)**
- See the employee resource groups entry

ages

Express ages in numerals (including **1 through 9**).

- 3-year-old girl
- 20-year-old law
- The girl is 2 years old.
- The girl, 6, has a brother, 16.
- The T-ball team is for 6-year-olds.
- The man is in his 30s.
- 30-something within in a sentence, but Thirty-something to start a sentence.

aid, aide

- **aid as a noun** means assistance: *Provide first aid to the victims.*
- **aid as a verb** means to help: *SEI aids investors in making informed decision.*
- **aide is a noun** meaning someone who serves as an assistant: *The president's aide responded to the questions.*

aka

- Abbreviation for "also known as"
- Never use a.k.a.

alongside

U.S. vs. U.K. spellings

English usage in the United States tends to simplify spellings phonetically (color, center), while in the United Kingdom, British English often retains French or German roots (colour, centre).

Major differences include -or/-our, -er/-re, -ize/-ise, and the doubling of “l”.

Key, consistent rules generally apply to specific word endings, though some exceptions exist. Keep these rules in mind while writing, editing SEI content.

Key spelling rules

-or (US) vs. -our (UK): American English drops the **u**.

- *US:* color, honor, labor, flavor, humor.
- *UK:* colour, honour, labour, flavour, humour.

-er (US) vs. -re (UK): American English reverses the ending.

- *US:* center, theater, meter, liter.
- *UK:* centre, theatre, metre, litre.

-ize (US) vs. -ise (UK): American English prefers **z**, while British English frequently uses **s**.

- *US:* organize, realize, apologize, analyze.
- *UK:* organise, realise, apologise, analyse.

Single “l” (US) vs. Double “ll” (UK): In American English, the ‘l’ is not doubl
when adding suffixes like -ed or -ing.

- *US:* traveled, canceled, jeweler, modeling

Brand positioning

At SEI, everything we do is grounded in a clear purpose: helping our clients turn complexity into opportunity.

We've created a framework that brings together the core elements of our brand—our vision, mission, and the principles that guide how we innovate, collaborate, and deliver results. It's a shared foundation for how we show up in the market, articulate our value, and consistently communicate the impact we create for our clients and partners.

Align your messages to this framework:



Our vision: To be the engine that powers the growth of the world's wealth.

Our mission: To leverage adaptive technology, integrated operations, and investment expertise to turn barriers into breakthroughs.

POSITIONING PILLARS

Innovation with Purpose	Insight that Drives Action	Personalizing the Experience	Collaborative Progress	Integrity and Trust
Innovation is more than a novelty; we tackle tough problems and deliver measurable results.	Our unique vantage point at the center of the financial industry provides us unrivaled expertise.	Custom solutions that simplify our client's financial ecosystem enabling a focus on outcomes, not obstacles.	We believe in co-creation. We partner across the industry to shape the future of investing.	We are steadfast in our commitment to transparency and delivering on promises.

Winning proposition: SEI is your partner in transforming challenges into opportunities through custom platforms, integrated operations, and investment solutions that are the force to simplify, innovate, and scale.

for ASSET MANAGERS	for BANK & WEALTH MANAGERS	for FINANCIAL ADVISORS	for INSTITUTIONAL INVESTORS	for SEI INVESTOR COMMUNITY
SEI partners with you to transform complexity into opportunity by integrating advanced technology, operational scale, and data-driven insights to power growth, transparency, and global reach in a rapidly evolving landscape.	SEI enables you to scale with confidence by delivering unified platforms, seamless digital experiences, and innovative solutions that drive efficiency, personalization, and sustainable client outcomes.	SEI equips you with the tools to thrive in an evolving financial landscape. By making private and public markets accessible, automating complexity, and providing insights that deliver differentiated value and lasting trust for your clients.	SEI empowers you with a holistic platform for governance, operational excellence, and innovation which in turn enables smarter capital deployment, risk management, and performance in a world of expanding opportunities and complexities.	SEI has a unique combination of adaptive technology, integrated operations, and investment expertise that give us an unmatched advantage over our competition and positions us for future growth.

Voice

Our brand voice is direct, approachable, and human. We strive to maintain consistent language and writing style across all audiences.

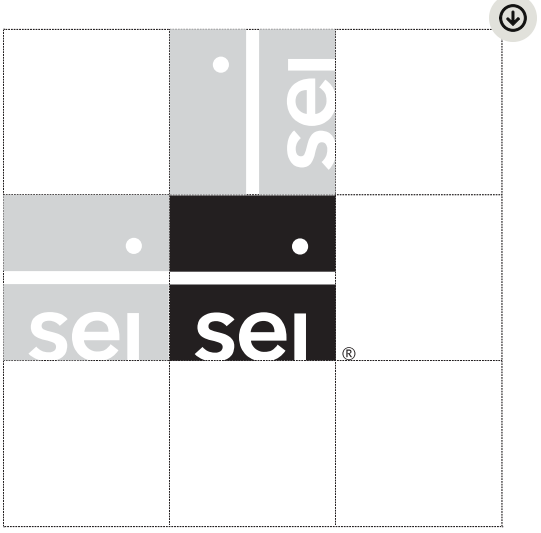
Brand positioning < > Logo



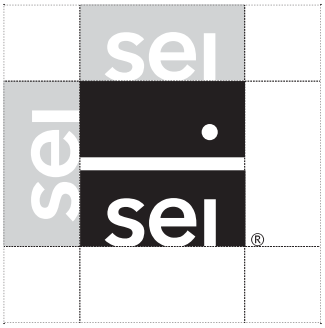
Logo size will always depend on the application. We do not have a universal maximum size constraint, but the smallest our logo should appear is 24px.

Clear space

Clear space is the specific amount of space our logo must have on all sides—it ensures our logo has adequate breathing room, preventing it from being too close to names, phrases, and third-party logos.



Recommended space



Acceptable space

Where space is limited, you can use the

Colors

We call our core palette “aspirational colors”. They’re bright and bold, just like our brand. Use all the colors generously, except for Red, which should be used sparingly.



Blue

0, 192, 243...

#00C0F3

70, 0, 100, 0

Pantone 2...



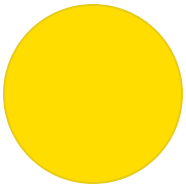
Green

166, 206, ...

#A6CE39

40, 20, 10...

Pantone 3...



Yellow

255, 221, 0...

#FFDD00

50, 10, 100...

Pantone 1...



Orange

250, 165, 2...

#FAA519

80, 40, 10...

Pantone 14...



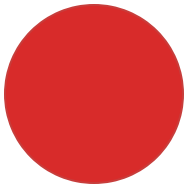
Pink

242, 135, 1...

#F287B7

0, 60, 0, 0

Pantone 2...



Red

216, 43, 42...

#D82B2A

5, 85, 80, 0

Pantone 7...

Typography

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Our brand font is: **Circular XX**.

Circular XX was selected for its humanistic quality. We use it on our website, marketing materials, and branded templates for internal and external use.

On rare occasion, when we cannot use Circular XX, we must instead use Calibri, or Arial for instances where a universal web font must be used.

Note: Our previous font, Kievit, is no longer licensed for use; all designs must use Circular XX going forward.

Photography

We build connections with our audiences by aligning photography with our corporate messaging.

Universal characteristics

These universal characteristics ensure that our images feel like part of the same brand:

1. Our subjects are real people, places, or things.
2. There is “visual air” — space for the eye to pause.
3. Creative crops create interest and spontaneity.
4. Our brand colors are reflected in our images.






Video

Video brings our brand to life. It's where ideas become stories, complex thinking becomes clear, and strategy turns into something you can see and feel. From product narratives to thought leadership, our videos are crafted to inform, inspire, and connect—always grounded in purpose and clarity.

Our internal team produces videos, photography and supports all audio needs using our on-site studio.

Photography Icons

Icons

Our icon style is simple, yet effective. We use outline icons with limited color to achieve brand cohesion. Our icons come from the Nucleo icon library.

Our icons



Color ratio

Charts

Information visualization should use vibrant flat color, remain clearly legible and use minimal linear elements.

Examples

